

was also known as Wi-Fi, but ‘Wi-Fi’ now encompasses newer standards such as 802.11a and 802.11g.

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802.11g

This describes a WLAN that operates in the 2.4 GHz frequency range. Over short distances, it provides a data throughput of up to 54 Mbps using orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) technology.

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802.1x

A security standard for wired and wireless LANs. It encapsulates EAP processes into Ethernet packets instead of using the protocol’s native PPP (Point-to-Point Protocol) environment, thus reducing some network overhead. It also puts the bulk of the processing burden upon the client and the authentication server (such as a RADIUS server), letting the ‘authenticator’ middleman simply pass the packets back and forth. Because the authenticator does so little, its role can be performed by a device with minimal processing power, such as an access point on a wireless network.

Access Point

Wirelessly networked devices usually connect to a wired LAN through a hardware device called an access point. Multiple access points set up in various locations let users roam from, say, their seats to a conference room to another cubicle, while staying connected.

An access point can also refer to one of the capabilities offered by a gateway or other networking device.